GuildofStudents
University of Birmingham

Job Description:
Student Basic Needs Coordinator

Job Title:	Student Basic Needs Coordinator
Responsible to:	The Community, Advice & Support Manager via the Senior Student Lifestyle Coordinator
Responsible for:	Student Staff Team (as appropriate)
Grade	Guild Grade B

Organisation:

This role is part of the Community, Advice & Support department working collectively with colleagues delivering the Guild's students advice, community engagement, and students wellbeing and lifestyle campaigns and activities. The Community, Advice & Support department is part of the Community & Representation Directorate.

Job Purpose:

The Student Basic Needs Coordinator role is to support the delivery of the Community, Advice & Support departmental plan. We expect Coordinators to help to create an inclusive and engaging environment for all.

The role is required:

- To deliver Cost-of-Living projects and initiatives, with a particular focus on basic needs, money/finance matters.
- To empower students to effectively manage their finances, studies, health and wellbeing.
- To work collaboratively with Guild and University colleagues, administrating Hardship funds and assisting students in understanding and accessing these.

Success in the role will require a highly student and customer focused approach together with an emphasis on teamwork. The role involves collaboration with internal and external stakeholders, acting as a positive ambassador for the Guild and facilitating under-represented groups to find a comfortable place here. Supporting a culture of ambitious targets and evaluation and promoting a positive team spirit are also key. Coordinators are expected to follow the Guild's competency framework, which should be read in conjunction with this job description.

Key Role Responsibilities:

1. To work with the Senior Student Lifestyle Coordinator and Community, Advice & Support Manager to ensure the effective delivery and implementation of support-based workshops, events, activities and campaigns.

2. To coordinate the daily operations of a diverse range of activities and initiatives within the Guild and across campus, aimed at supporting students' financial wellbeing in response to the rising cost of living.

3. To collaborate across the organisation to support the implementation of university-wide campaigns addressing students basic needs in relation to cost-of-living.

4. To support the development and planning of initiatives, such as Money Matters, Community Pantry & Community Breakfast.

5. To capture both quantitative data and qualitative student feedback to shape services and delivery that empowers students to effectively manage their finances, studies, health and wellbeing

6. To evaluate the impact of our work dedicated to supporting students on low incomes. Identify gaps in communication and delivery and provide recommendations on how to tailor our support around student finance.

7. To be aware of appropriate emergency/crisis procedures and referral pathways, supporting the Senior Student Lifestyle Coordinator to implement these effectively.

8. To maintain up-to-date knowledge of current student needs and expectations, as well as developments in UK student finance policies and practices.

9. To support the dissemination of relevant finance information to students on relevant issues, empowering access to support services internally within the Guild and University, and externally with local authorities.

10. To assist the Senior Student Lifestyle Coordinator in the recruitment, supervision, and training of the student staff team and volunteers.

11. To develop and maintain effective working relationships with key internal and external stakeholders.

12. To assist, where necessary, in moving items or equipment to events across campus.

13. To Identify improvements and recommend these to the Senior Student Lifestyle Coordinator and Community, Advice & Support Manager for consideration.

General Duties:

14. To undertake appropriate induction and ongoing training and personal development as required for the role.

15. To adhere to all relevant Guild Policy with reference to HR, staffing, health & safety, data protection, environmental, and any other specific Guild Policy where it may impact upon your role.

16. To be familiar with the Guild's competency framework, striving always to demonstrate the positive behaviours which drive the highest standards of personal and organisational performance in supporting our students. Grade B Coordinators should be developing within level 1 of the six competencies (Student and Customer Focus, Accountability, Results Focus, Inclusivity, Communication and Teamwork) which is designed to support staff to achieve high performance.

17. To act as a role model in portraying a positive image of the Guild both internally and externally, acting as an ambassador and displaying high standards of personal integrity and professionalism.

18. To support the work of the Community, Advice & Support Team, where necessary, in the event of sickness, holiday or other exceptional circumstances.

19. To undertake such other duties as may be reasonably required, consistent with the nature and grade of the post.

January 2026

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Person Specification: Student Basic Needs Coordinator

You must be able to demonstrate in your application that you have:

QUALIFICATIONS	Essential	Desirable
Good general education, typically to A-Level standard including Maths and English at least to GSCE or equivalent	✓	
EXPERIENCE		
Experience of working with students in a support, basic needs, mental health, money/finance or campaigning role.	✓	
Experience of successfully working with a team to deliver a service or project	✓	
Experience of supporting and delivering events, activities and/or campaigns	✓	
Experience of developing relationships with students and stakeholders to deliver objectives	✓	
Experience of working effectively with others on cross-organisational projects	✓	
SKILLS AND KNOWLEDGE		
Knowledge and experience of financial issues affecting students, such as debt and hardship	✓	
Knowledge and understanding of basic needs - food, security, housing and/or mental health.	✓	
Effective organisation and administration skills, to include data collation, and coordination of student staff rota	✓	
Ability to communicate effectively with students one-to-one and in groups.	✓	
Ability to contribute to organisation-wide initiatives	✓	
Good IT skills including proficiency in Microsoft Office including digital systems	✓	
Ability to effectively promote, and support the delivery of a service	✓	
Ability to take a collaborative approach to solving problems	✓	
Ability to balance the needs of individuals and team/organisation	✓	
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Ability to work effectively within a democratic structure		✓
PERSONAL QUALITIES		
Motivated by working in a student-led, democratic workplace	✓	

Student & Customer focus: Keeps student leadership and the needs of students and customers at the heart of activities	✓	
Accountability: Takes personal responsibility for the important role they play in the Guild's work and in wider society	✓	
Results Focus: Strives for the best results – gets things done on time and to a high standard	✓	
Inclusivity: Values diversity - works to create an inclusive and engaging environment across all our activities and services	✓	
Communication: Communicates clearly and appropriately to people across our students' union and outside	✓	
Teamwork: Builds good relationships and works effectively with a range of people to deliver our shared goals	✓	